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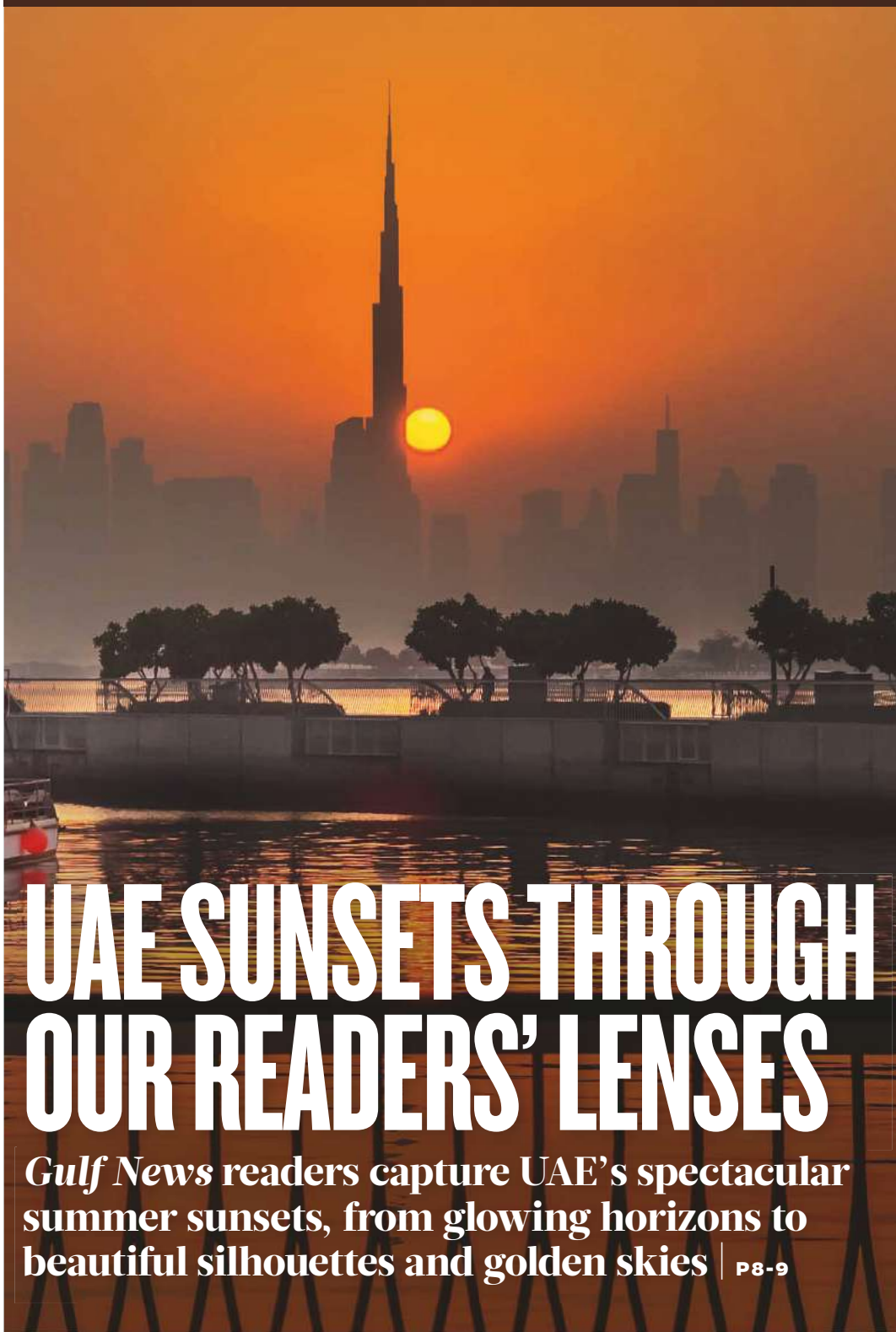


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UAE SUNSETS THROUGH OUR READERS' LENSES

Gulf News readers capture UAE's spectacular summer sunsets, from glowing horizons to beautiful silhouettes and golden skies | P8-9

Photo by Hamd Ullah

Abu Dhabi to Bollywood: Benny Dayal comes home

Singer thrives on home-bred resilience

DUBAI
BY MANJUSHA
RADHAKRISHNAN
Entertainment, Lifestyle
and Sport Editor

Bollywood hitmaker Benny Dayal may have conquered stages across India and beyond, but the singer has no doubts about where his hustle was born: Abu Dhabi.

"I owe a lot of it to Abu Dhabi as my hometown, because I feel every Abu Dhabi kid is a very different kid," Dayal tells *Gulf News*. "Abu Dhabi kids can actually survive anywhere they go. We are all hustlers."

That Abu Dhabi-bred resilience served him well when Dayal set his sights on India's fiercely competitive music industry. "The hustle is not easy," he admits. "We are living in a country with 1.4 billion people."

For the uninitiated, Dayal is one of Indian playback music's most distinctive voices. Born in Abu Dhabi to Malayali parents, he found his breakthrough after being spotted by Oscar-winning

composer A.R. Rahman and went on to power Bollywood chartbusters including *Badtameez Dil*, *Let's Nacho* and *Ude Dil Befikre*.

"To be recognised by the greatest composer of the country and then to have a body of work is the most beautiful thing," he says.

Now, Dayal returns to the UAE for *Thaalum Beats*



at Dubai's Coca-Cola Arena alongside Usha Uthup and Thaikkudam Bridge, promising audiences his "full-throttle concert".

He also opens up about staying relevant, refusing to be boxed in by age and why AI doesn't frighten him. His approach to fame is equally grounded. "Everybody has their time," Dayal says. "This too shall pass, but it shall come back again too."

SEE ALSO P11

UAE football makes a bold statement by roping in Dalic

Croatian's experience in the region likely to make a big difference to UAE's prospects

DUBAI
BY ROBERT ILSLEY
Sports Reporter

The UAE Football Association has made a major statement of intent by appointing Croatian Zlatko Dalic as the national team's new head coach.

The 59-year-old returns to the UAE, where he previously guided Al Ain to the domestic league title in 2015, after an impressive career in both Middle Eastern club football and on the international stage.

Dalic's experience in the region, including spells with Al-Faisaly, Al-Hilal and Al Ain, means he already understands the culture and football landscape.

However, his achievements with Croatia are what make the appointment particularly significant. He led Croatia to the 2018 World Cup final and third place at the 2022 World Cup,

CONSUMERS FACE PAIN AMID PROLONGED HORMUZ CRISIS

Iran rejects Trump claim of strait control

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The world survived the first oil shock of the US-Iran war. Nearly six months later, the buffer that helped protect consumers from an even bigger hit is getting thinner.

Global oil stockpiles are rapidly diminishing as traffic through the Strait of Hormuz remains effectively stalled, raising a worrying question: How long can the disruption continue before consumers face another round of pain?

Iran yesterday declared that the strait remained under its control, directly challenging US President Donald Trump's assertion that Washington "owns" the strategic waterway.

"Today, you see that the Strait of Hormuz is under the management and control of the Islamic republic," Hossein Taeb, head of the Basij forces affiliated with Iran's Revolutionary Guards, said, according to AFP.

Only a fraction through

Hormuz normally carries around 20 per cent of the world's oil, but traffic remains a fraction of pre-war levels. Only 14 vessels crossed the strait on Tuesday, compared with roughly 120 ships a day before the war.

For months, the global economy has adapted by drawing oil from inventories, increasing production elsewhere, adjusting supply chains and reducing con-

DP WORLD REVENUE RISES 13.1%

DP World reported first-half 2026 revenue of \$12.7 billion, up 13.1 per cent year on year, as growth across Logistics, Marine Services and its international Ports and Terminals portfolio helped offset lower activity at Jebel Ali. "Jebel Ali remains fully operational with no physical damage, although the regional conflict has temporarily reduced vessel traffic," DP World said.

The company said it implemented mitigation measures across its regional network, including expanded inland connectivity, to support the continued movement of critical cargo.

Excluding Jebel Ali, container volumes increased 6.5 per cent on a like-for-like basis, while adjusted EBITDA rose 9.7 per cent, with growth across Africa, Asia Pacific, Europe and the Americas.

DP World also plans to develop two new terminals in Fujairah under a 50-year concession, extending the Jebel Ali ecosystem and strengthening the resilience and flexibility of the UAE's trade infrastructure.

—Nivetha Dayanand, Assistant Business Editor

sumption. But those buffers are not unlimited.

The International Energy Agency said this week that elevated fuel prices and the continuing Hormuz closure are already weighing on consumption, with global oil demand forecast to fall by 1.6 million barrels a day this year. "The ongoing closure of the Strait of Hormuz and elevated fuel prices continue to weigh on oil consumption," the IEA said.

Higher crude prices feed through to transport, industry and petrochemicals, raising the cost of energy and moving and producing goods. Prolonged increases can eventually work their way through economies and reach consumers far beyond petrol stations.

The danger is what happens if the disruption continues while the inventories cushioning the

impact keep shrinking. "Few merchant shipping companies and their ships are confident that the US can ensure their safe transit of the strait," said Carl Schuster, former director of the US Pacific Command's Joint Intelligence Centre.

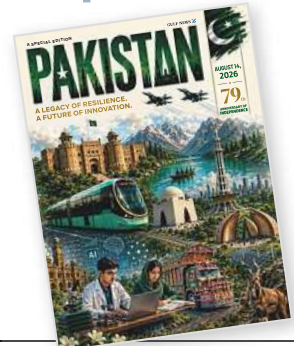
Those fears are hardly unfounded. At least four vessels were attacked by drones and missiles in the strait last week alone, while the continuing danger has also pushed up insurance costs.

For consumers, that is why dwindling oil stockpiles matter even when crude prices are not continuously surging: inventories have helped absorb the disruption so far, but every barrel drawn from that cushion leaves less protection against the next shock.

SEE ALSO P6, P-1, IV

SPECIAL REPORT

Pakistan celebrates 79th anniversary of independence



FRIDAY

Eight-year-old Emirati author publishes his first comic book, and more

